

THINKING SMALL

Cellphones aren't all about touch screens, five megapixel cameras, and a burning hole in your pocket. We showcase 16 affordable marvels

Michael Browne

When we think of cellphones we usually visualise a good camera, WLAN connectivity for web browsing and a touch screen for fun interfacing. The average metropolitan has seen so many high-end cellphones that some of us forget that there is a whole new world that exists apart from PDAs and smartphones – a world for those of us that need just a phone. This may seem contrary to the aspirations of a college student or even those of a rickshaw driver who might yearn to own a Nokia N96 or an Apple iPhone. But the fact remains that while these phones are indeed worthy of pursuit, not every-

body can afford to purchase one. Moreover, not everyone may even want to purchase one. There are even those people who already have a high-end uber cellphone and they need another cheaper, no-frills device mainly for making calls.

Through the following pages we address the bottom rung of the handset market. This market is dominated by CDMA (Code Division Multiple Access) handsets and a few cheaper GSM (General Subscriber Module) handsets. There are many people

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